



Everyone is a founder

Tyler Lindow · Founder & CEO of beginner

Pre-seed · \$500k

Team

- Solo founder. 15 years building the bridge between makers and money.
- Maker-museum education & research · First-generation education · Merchant onboarding for a payment network.
- The thread: never the gatekeeper, always the bridge.

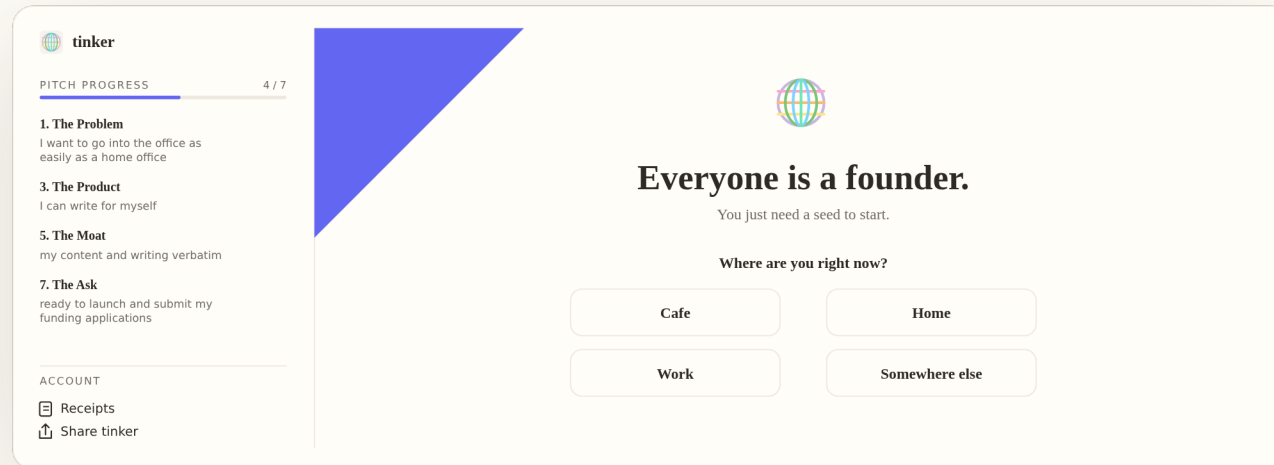
Problem

Solo founders pay \$500–\$5,000 a month to fractional fundraising coaches and deck writers to package their conviction into something an investor will read.

The market exists. The price is set. Founders who can't afford it don't get funded.

Solution

A guided AI interview that turns conviction into a page seeders read. \$9/mo entry. Same deliverable as the coach. 1/100th the price.



The screenshot shows the tinker app interface. On the left is a sidebar with the tinker logo, a 'PITCH PROGRESS' bar at 4/7, and a list of seven steps: 1. The Problem, 3. The Product, 5. The Moat, and 7. The Ask. Below this is an 'ACCOUNT' section with links for 'Receipts' and 'Share tinker'. The main content area features a blue triangle graphic, the tinker logo, the headline 'Everyone is a founder.' with the subtext 'You just need a seed to start.', and the question 'Where are you right now?'. Four buttons are displayed: 'Cafe', 'Home', 'Work', and 'Somewhere else'.

tinker

PITCH PROGRESS 4 / 7

1. The Problem
I want to go into the office as easily as a home office

3. The Product
I can write for myself

5. The Moat
my content and writing verbatim

7. The Ask
ready to launch and submit my funding applications

ACCOUNT

Receipts

Share tinker

tinker

Everyone is a founder.
You just need a seed to start.

Where are you right now?

Cafe Home

Work Somewhere else

Traction

10

paying users on tinker today. CAC: \$9/user (excludes infra/scaling). At the \$9/mo entry tier, LTV beats CAC inside month two.

Market

\$2.4B / year

1M aspiring founders globally × \$2,400 / year (Enterprise + community tier ACV).

The aspiring-founder market is the people who already buy fundraising coaches, accelerator prep, and pitch tools — at the price point where beginner clears them all.

Ask

\$500k → 4,000 paid users @ \$9/mo (~\$432k ARR) + 1 named accelerator deal in 12 months.

\$168k — founder cost (12 months: \$150k base + \$18k benefits). I need a salary; this is what it is.

\$200k — founder events, travel, accelerator BD. SD farmers-market activations, EvoNexus / SDSU / UCSD / Nucleate partnerships, accelerator pipeline trips.

\$132k — growth + infrastructure scaling. 4,000 users × \$9 CAC = \$36k paid; remainder covers funnel, community, and infra beyond a16z Speedrun credits.

Line in the sand: personal runway ends June 2026 — if the round doesn't close, I step away.

Thank you

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